

ESCAPE THE WEEK

How it works

1. Each lock has three answers. Pick the best one as a team.
2. Every answer has a letter. Write your letter in your book.
3. When you have 7 letters, unscramble them into ONE word.
4. Real word? You have escaped. Not a word? One answer is wrong. Go back and check.

1 LOCK 1 reading between the lines

Mr Tan's desk was cleared except for a single potted plant. A card on it said "Good luck!" in twenty different handwritings, and someone had already taken his name off the door.

What has most likely happened?

- S** Mr Tan is going on holiday, and his class has signed a card.
- E** Mr Tan is leaving the school and is not coming back.
- T** Mr Tan is moving to a different desk in the same building.

2 LOCK 2 explaining evidence

Point: Grandad is lonely. Evidence: he "talks to the radio as if it might answer".

Which explanation would earn the mark?

- R** This shows that Grandad is lonely, which is why he talks to the radio so much.
- A** "Talks to the radio" is personification, which makes the reader feel sorry for him.
- K** Treating the radio as company suggests he rarely has a real person to talk to.

3 LOCK 3 figurative language

The exam hall was a fridge: every breath, every pencil-scratch, every swallowed cough hung in the cold air.

Which answer explains the writer's choice best?

- W** Metaphor. Even tiny sounds seem frozen in the still air, so the silence feels tense.
- O** Simile. It compares the hall to a fridge to show that the heating had been switched off.
- M** Metaphor. It makes the description more vivid, so the reader can really picture the hall.

4 LOCK 4 the writer's choices

Everyone said the river was safe in summer. Everyone said the current wasn't strong. Everyone was wrong.

Why does the writer repeat "Everyone"?

- P** To show that lots of different people at the river were all saying the same thing.
- L** To create suspense, so the reader really wants to know what happens next.
- E** To build false confidence, so the short last sentence comes as a shock.

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5 LOCK 5 words in context

The manager's reply was curt: two words, no greeting and no signature.
Which is closest to the meaning of "curt"?

I
N
U

- short but polite
- short and unfriendly
- angry and shouting

6 LOCK 6 what words point to

The school banned phones at lunch, moved the clubs to the morning and cancelled the Friday disco. That was the decision that finally made the students complain.
What does "That" refer to?

D
B
G

- cancelling the Friday disco
- all three of the changes
- banning phones at lunch

7 LOCK 7 spotting the spin

SUNNYVALE JUICE: now with 30% less sugar than our original recipe! Loved by kids everywhere.

The advert wants you to think the juice is healthy. Which answer best shows it has not proved that?

Y
E
H

- "Loved by kids everywhere" is only an opinion, and nobody could ever ask every child.
- It is only 30% less than their own old recipe, which may have been very sugary.
- Fruit juice is full of natural sugar, so it is never healthy, whatever the advert says.

Your 7 letters: _ _ _ _ _

The word: _____

Escaped? MAKE A LOCK

On a clean page in one book, write a lock for the other teams.
Copy the layout above: a short sentence, a question, and three answers with a letter each. Only one answer is right. Your teacher will start a lock carousel when everyone is ready.